

Avery C Ellis

acellis@berkeley.edu

averycellis.github.io

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley, Berkeley, CA

Aug. 2026 -

Ph.D. in Political Science

Expected Fields: Political Methodology, Political Behavior, American Politics

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Champaign, IL

Jan. 2025 - May 2025

Non-Degree Coursework in Mathematics

Selected Coursework: Real Analysis

Bowdoin College, Brunswick, ME

Aug. 2019 - May 2024

A.B. (with highest honors), Mathematics and Government & Legal Studies

Selected Coursework: Bayesian Statistics, Advanced Topics in Mathematical Modeling, Algorithms, Data Structures, Methodologies of Political Behavior, Advanced Quantitative Analysis in Political Science

RESEARCH INTERESTS

American political behavior, political methodology, causal inference, Bayesian methods

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Modeling the Development & Expression of Political Behavior: A Zallerian Approach

Undergraduate honors thesis, awarded highest departmental honors.

Using Threat to Value and Contextualize On-Puck Actions (with Matthew Hurley)

2021 Big Data Cup Honorable Mention, Undergraduate Category

WORKING PROJECTS

Replicating and Extending Zaller's Receive-Accept-Sample Model

Open-Ended Survey Responses, Attitudes, and Embeddings

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Ellis, A., Hurley, M. Player Metrics [Panel session]. 2021 Ottawa Hockey Analytics Conference, virtual. (2021, March 26-27). https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HxhMuM1YQ_c.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Latin School of Chicago, Chicago, IL

- **AP Calculus AB**, Teaching Assistant Spring 2021
- **Honors Precalculus**, Co-Teacher Fall 2020 & Spring 2021 (2 sections)
- **Honors Geometry**, Co-Teacher Fall 2020 & Spring 2021

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Quantitative Research Associate, Fidelity Investments Sept. 2025 - Jan. 2026
Analyzed alternative datasets to identify alpha-generating signals in ESG data using Python and SQL. Collaborated with fundamental equity research analysts to define, measure, & backtest drivers of financial materiality. Conducted panel time-series regression to separate ESG factors from traditional financial drivers of returns; published internal research paper quantifying precise impact of unpriced ESG factor and its impact on forward returns.

Data Analyst, Fidelity Investments Oct. 2024 - June 2025
Shadowed senior statisticians to observe development of causal inference-based synthetic control matching tool. Conducted regression utilizing R and SQL to identify customer-level and client-level drivers of cost increases. Transformed and displayed data in Power BI and Tableau to outline participant demographics and eliminate repetitive ad-hoc requests.

AWARDS

Berkeley Fellow for Graduate Study (University of California, Berkeley)	April 2026
Highest Honors (Bowdoin College Dept. of Government & Legal Studies)	May 2024
2nd Team, All-Academic (American Collegiate Rowing Association)	May 2023 & 2024
Honorable Mention (Big Data Cup)	March 2021

SKILLS

Languages: Python (numpy, pandas, statsmodels, scipy, scikit-learn), R (tidyverse, rstan), SQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL), Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Java

Statistical Techniques: MCMC (Gibbs, Metropolis-Hastings, Hamiltonian Monte Carlo), Bayesian Methods, Time-Series, Hierarchical Modeling